

Xinglang Zhang

normanspark@hust.edu.cn | [GitHub](#) | [Personal Page](#)

Education

Huazhong University of Science and Technology (HUST)

Sept 2024 – Jun 2028

B.S. in Cyber Science and Engineering

- **GPA:** 4.80/5.0 **Weighted Avg:** 94.51 **Rank:** 1/108
- **Selected Coursework:** Calculus A (I/II) (A+), Linear Algebra (A+), Discrete Math (A+), Data Structures (A+), Assembly Language (A+), Probability Theory (A+), Digital Circuit (A+), Database Systems (A+).
- **Research Interests:** LLM Reasoning, LLM Test-Time Training, Neural-Symbolic AI, Agents, Tool Learning

Publications

- [1] **Logical Phase Transitions: Understanding Collapse in LLM Logical Reasoning**
*Xinglang Zhang**, Yunyao Zhang*, et al. | **ACL 2026** (Main Conference) | [\[ArXiv\]](#) | [\[Code\]](#)
- [2] **Semantic-Aware Logical Reasoning via a Semiotic Framework**
Yunyao Zhang, Xinglang Zhang, et al. | **ACL 2026 (Oral)** | [\[ArXiv\]](#) | [\[Code\]](#)
- [3] **TRACE: Transfer-Aware Test-Time Training for Tool-Using LLMs**
Xinglang Zhang, Cheng Qian | [\[Paper\]](#) | Conference Submission
- [4] **Too Good to Be Real? Diagnosing and Reducing the Gap Between AI Preference and Real User Engagement**
Xinglang Zhang, Yuanmeng Xiang, et al. | [\[ArXiv\]](#) | Conference Submission
- [5] **Semiotic Logical Hexagon Theory for LLM Logical Reasoning**
Yunyao Zhang, Xinglang Zhang*, et al.* | [\[ArXiv\]](#) | [\[Code\]](#) | Journal Submission
- [6] **Social Intelligence Modeling: A Comprehensive Survey from Social Perception to Social Simulation**
Zikai Song, Xiajie Li, Yunyao Zhang, Xinglang Zhang, et al. | [\[Paper\]](#) | [\[GitHub\]](#)
- [7] **IntervenSim: Intervention-Aware Social Network Simulation for Opinion Dynamics**
Yunyao Zhang, Zuocheng Ying, Xinglang Zhang | [\[ArXiv\]](#) | [\[Code\]](#)
- [8] **EarthVerse: Benchmarking Scientific Agents Across Dynamic Earth Systems and Natural Hazards**
Zhiqing Cui, Xinxiang Yin, Yihong Tang, Xinglang Zhang, et al. | [\[Project Page\]](#) | [\[Paper\]](#)

Research Experience

TRACE: Transfer-Aware Test-Time Training for Tool-Using LLMs

Jul 2026 – Present

Research Intern, BLENDER Lab, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)

Mentor: [Cheng Qian](#) Advisor: [Heng Ji](#)

Research Areas: Test-Time Training, Tool Learning, LLM Agents, Adaptive Data Selection

- **Framework:** Defined *Transfer Value* as the target-specific, state-dependent benefit of learning from a self-generated experience.
- **Method:** Developed *TRACE*, a gold-free curriculum combining Target Relevance, Current-State Transferability, and Marginal Complementarity through temporary updates and probes.
- **Findings:** Current-state feedback improved selection over stale signals; dynamic selection consistently outperformed a fixed curriculum.
- **Results:** Across four tool-use benchmarks and four main models, improved Overall Exact accuracy over frozen models by 13.10–24.42 percentage points. First-author **ACL 2027** submission [3] under review.

Hexagonal Semantic Reasoning for Reliable LLMs

Mar 2026 – Jul 2026

Research Assistant, Intelligent Media Computing and Network Security Lab, HUST

Advisor: [Zikai Song](#), Research Areas: Neuro-Symbolic AI, Semantic Reasoning, LLM Reliability

- **Framework:** Proposed *HexLogicAgent*, a semantic-aware logical reasoning framework that organizes proposition meanings through a logical hexagon before deduction and verification.
- **Theory:** Developed a formal logical hexagon theory for semantic reasoning.
- **Results:** Achieved consistent gains across five logical reasoning benchmarks.
- **Outcome:** Co-first-author **Artificial Intelligence** submission [5].

Diagnosing and Correcting Synthetic-Real Preference Misalignment in Online Argumentation

Jan 2026 – May 2026

Project Leader, Intelligent Media Computing and Network Security Lab, HUST

Advisor: [Zikai Song](#), Research Areas: Preference Alignment, Social Media Analysis, Controllable Text Generation

- **Framework:** Proposed *Ontological Preference Measurement* to diagnose synthetic-real preference mismatch across logic, affect, and expression dimensions.
- **Method:** Developed *OMRA* to mask and reconstruct reasoning scaffolds while preserving stance and coherence.

- **Results:** Reduced marginal, geometric, and transfer gaps by 54.4% on average across four LLM families; first-author NAACL 2027 submission [4]. All three reviewers gave an **OA score of 3.5/5**; top 8% of submissions.

Exploring Logical Reasoning Boundaries and Enhancement Strategies in LLMs via Neural-Symbolic Methods

Aug 2025 – Jan 2026

Project Leader, Intelligent Media Computing and Network Security Lab, HUST

Advisor: [Zikai Song](#), Research Areas: LLM Evaluation, Logical Reasoning, Neural-Symbolic AI

- **Framework:** Identified *Logical Phase Transitions* in LLM reasoning and proposed a *Neural-Symbolic Tuning* framework to stabilize reasoning under increasing logical complexity.
- **Results:** Across five benchmarks, the method mitigates reasoning collapse, yielding +1.26 (naive) and +3.95 (CoT) average accuracy gains with improved generalization.
- **Outcome:** Published as first author in **ACL 2026 Main Conference** [1].

Reasoning Framework for Large LLMs based on Philosophical Paradigms

Feb 2025 – Aug 2025

Research Assistant, Intelligent Media Computing and Network Security Lab, HUST

Advisor: [Zikai Song](#), Research Areas: LLM Reasoning, Neural-Symbolic AI, Semantic and Symbolic Reasoning

- **Framework & Benchmark:** Proposed *LogicAgent*, a semiotic-aware logical reasoning framework, and introduced *RepublicQA*, a benchmark jointly modeling logical and semantic complexity.
- **Results:** Achieved state-of-the-art results on RepublicQA (+6.25%) and strong generalization across four logical reasoning benchmarks (+7.05%).
- **Outcome:** Co-authored paper published in **ACL 2026 Main Conference** [2].

Selected Funded Projects

- **HUST Undergraduate Natural Science Fund, 2026** — *Trustworthy Enhancement for Complex Reasoning*; Project Lead; CNY 50,000 (approx. US\$7,450)
- **College Student Innovation and Entrepreneurship Program (University Level)** — *LLM Logical Reasoning through Philosophical Paradigms*; Project Lead; CNY 4,000 (approx. US\$600)
- **College Student Innovation and Entrepreneurship Program (Hubei Provincial Level)** — *Trustworthy Enhancement of LLMs via a Neuro-Symbolic Framework*; Project Lead; CNY 20,000 (approx. US\$2,980)

Honors

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|---|-------------|
| • Outstanding Student , Qiming College (<i>Highest Honor for HUST Undergraduates; Top 1.85%</i>) | 2025 – 2027 |
| • Jin Yugang Lan-Ying Scholarship (<i>Top 1%</i>) | 2025 – 2026 |
| • National Scholarship (<i>Highest Honor for Chinese Undergraduates; Top 0.3% Nationwide</i>) | 2025 – 2026 |
| • Triple-A ("Sanhao") Student Scholarship (<i>Top 5.5%</i>) | 2025 – 2026 |
| • National Scholarship (<i>Highest Honor for Chinese Undergraduates; Top 0.3% Nationwide</i>) | 2024 – 2025 |
| • Triple-A ("Sanhao") Student Scholarship (<i>Top 5.5%</i>) | 2024 – 2025 |
| • Outstanding Youth League Member (<i>Top 4.1%</i>) | 2024 – 2025 |
| • Outstanding Youth League Cadre (<i>Top 4.1%</i>) | 2024 – 2025 |
| • Academic Excellence Scholarship & Self-improvement Scholarship (<i>Top 10%</i>) | 2024 – 2025 |

Service

Reviewer, ACL ARR

January, May, and August 2026

Academic Activities

ACL 2026 Poster Presenter and Oral Presenter

July 1 – 8, 2026

X-AGI Conference Rising Star Poster Presenter

October 17 – 18, 2026

Leadership Experience

- **Class Representative, Qiming Experimental Class 2401** Sept 2024 – Present
 - Organized academic events, managed administrative tasks, and mentored students to enhance class cohesion.
- **Head of Organization Department, School of Cyber Science and Engineering** Sept 2025 – Present
 - Managed administrative and organizational affairs for the Communist Youth League.
- **Head of Lesson Planning, Peer Lecturer Group** Apr 2025 – Present
 - Fostered academic excellence across the college through peer mentoring and curriculum planning.

Skills

ML & Research Stack: Python, C/C++, PyTorch, HuggingFace, LoRA, SFT, RLHF, vLLM, Poster Creation

Mathematical Foundations: Linear Algebra, Probability Theory, Calculus, Discrete Mathematics

Languages: English (TOEFL 5.5/6; W6 R6 L5.5 S5; CET-4: 609; CET-6: 611), Chinese (Native)